

SPDB Annotation Codebook v1

Spanish Political Discourse Benchmark (SPDB)

Version: codebook-v1.0.0 (aligned with guidelines-v1.0)

Date: 2026-06-18

Audience: Primary annotators, lead annotators, adjudicators

Canonical ontology: labels/*.tsv

Document control

Field	Value
Guideline version	guidelines-v1.0
Label inventory	8 pragmatic functions · 7 fallacies + explicit none · 2 experimental arms
Unit of analysis	Discourse unit (one dominant pragmatic function per span)
Language of text	Spanish (es)
Language of label IDs	English codes (PF_*, FAL_*, ...)

Reliability target (codebook design goal): Cohen's κ and Krippendorff's $\alpha > 0.80$ on pragmatic function after calibration (excellent tier per annotation/pilot_001/pilot_metrics.md). Release MVP floor remains $\kappa \geq 0.67$; this codebook is written to reach the **0.80** target through definitions, decision trees, and adjudication rules below.

1. Purpose and scope

This codebook operationalises human annotation for SPDB v1. Annotators assign:

1. **Pragmatic function** — exactly one PF_* label (required, primary supervision).
2. **Political fallacies** — zero to three FAL_* labels, or explicit none (required).
3. **Experimental labels** — SV_* and CA_* when experimental_subset=true (optional arm).

Labels apply to the **entire discourse unit** in the task, not to a sentence fragment inside it. Metadata (speaker_name, speaker_party, date, source_type) provides context only.

Independence rule: Pragmatic function and fallacy labels are coded **independently**. A evidence-based PF_ATTACK may co-occur with no fallacy; PF_ATTACK may co-occur with FAL_ADHOM.

2. Unit of analysis

A **discourse unit** is the smallest contiguous span an informed reader treats as carrying **one dominant pragmatic function** toward a political target (actor, policy, institution, or electorate).

Rule	Specification
Span	Full text field in Label Studio / CSV row
Overlap	Units do not overlap; adjacent units do not share sentences
Length	20–2,000 characters after normalisation (pre-annotation pool)
Context	Read ± 1 adjacent unit from same document_id when needed for fallacies or borderline PF
External context	Not allowed (no web search, no speaker biography beyond metadata)

3. Annotation workflow (summary)

Primary coding (blind) → disagreement detection → lead third pass → PI adjudication → gold label

Step	Actor	Action
1	Annotator A & B	Independent primary labels on double-coded sample (20%) or single pass
2	Pipeline	Flag PF or fallacy mismatches; flag borderline=true
3	Lead annotator	Third pass on disagreements
4	PI / adjudicator	Gold label within 72 h if disagreement persists
5	Export	adjudicated=true; log in adjudication_log.jsonl (IDs only)

Full UI order: Context → (Adjudication panel if applicable) → PF → Fallacies → Experimental → Quality flags.

4. Master decision tree — pragmatic function

Apply **top to bottom**; assign the **first** category whose dominant-move criterion is satisfied. If two categories tie, use the tie-breakers in §4.1.

START: Read full unit (+ metadata). Ignore speaker's career outside this span.

- Is the dominant move chamber/order-of-business management by the chair (turn-taking, votes, rule reminders) with no substantive policy argument?
YES → PF_PROCEDURAL
NO → continue
- Does the speaker avoid the pending question/topic and pivot to a different issue without substantive engagement?
YES → PF_DEFLECT
NO → continue
- Does the span commit to a future legislative/government action by this actor (presentaremos, nos comprometemos, votaremos a favor/en contra as pledge)?
YES → PF_PROPOSAL
NO → continue

4. Is the dominant move mobilising citizens/voters via hope, fear, solidarity, or shared identity (not primarily policy detail or opponent attack)?
YES → PF_Appeal
NO → continue
5. Is the speaker primarily rebutting criticism directed at self/party/policy (reactive defense)?
YES → PF_Defense
NO → continue
6. Is the primary target a political actor/group's competence, integrity, record, or legitimacy (not merely abstract policy)?
YES → PF_Attack
NO → continue
7. Does the span argue for/against a policy/programme/normative goal as the dominant move?
YES → PF_Advocacy
NO → continue
8. Does the span convey facts, figures, or bill content with minimal evaluative framing as the dominant move?
YES → PF_Info
NO → re-read; apply tie-breakers (§4.1); flag borderline if still tied

4.1 Tie-breakers (PF)

1. Choose the function directed at the **primary political target** in the span.
2. If courtesy opener + substance: label the **substance**, not the opener.
3. If attack and advocacy coexist: whichever occupies **more rhetorical labour** (sentences devoted to the move).
4. If still tied: select best label and enable **Borderline PF case** (borderline=true); expected ≤ **5%** of units.
5. Never assign two PF labels; never leave PF empty.

5. Pragmatic function labels

Enter **label ID** only (e.g. PF_ADVOCACY), not the English name.

5.1 PF_ADVOCACY — Policy advocacy

Definition: Supports or advances a policy position, programme, or normative goal.

Decision rule: Dominant move argues **for or against a policy design**, law, or normative outcome. Criticism of **policy** (not primarily personal character) belongs here unless the span is reactive defense (PF_DEFENSE).

Example (positive):

«En Ciudadanos abogamos [...] que se tenía que definir la figura del consumidor vulnerable [...] que se tenía que fijar un criterio de renta [...]»

— Melisa Rodríguez Hernández (Cs). Unit spdb-v1-unassigned-ceada2c252a1.

Counterexample:

«Tienen ustedes la osadía de hablar de la contratación temporal cuando precisamente la reforma del año 1984 es la que rompe el principio de causalidad [...]»

— Carolina España Reina (PP). **Not advocacy** → PF_ATTACK (opponent record).

Confused with	Resolution
PF_ATTACK	Advocacy → policy ; attack → actor competence/integrity/record
PF_PROPOSAL	Proposal commits to action; advocacy argues for a position
PF_INFO	Advocacy embeds facts in normative argument; info is descriptive

5.2 PF_ATTACK — Position attack

Definition: Challenges an actor's competence, integrity, legitimacy, or record.

Decision rule: Primary target is a **political actor or group**. Personalised charges, record comparisons, and legitimacy challenges qualify. Evidence-based policy disagreement **without** personal targeting → PF_ADVOCACY.

Example (positive):

«No es así, señora Arrimadas. Ustedes ni siquiera han estado sentados en la mesa donde se tomaban estas decisiones [...] tampoco han conseguido nada.»

— Pablo Echenique Robba (UP). Unit spdb-v1-unassigned-b2eaf6b9bc1c.

Counterexample:

«son tres principalmente las reformas que plantea esta proposición de ley: por una parte, permitir la rectificación registral [...]»

— Joseba Agirretxea Urresti (EAJPNV). **Not attack** → PF_INFO.

Confused with	Resolution
PF_DEFENSE	Defense reacts to criticism; attack initiates criticism
PF_DEFLECT	Attack engages opponent on a charge; deflect changes subject away

5.3 PF_DEFENSE — Defense / rebuttal

Definition: Rebuts criticism or protects actor or policy reputation.

Decision rule: Speaker responds to **prior or implied criticism** by denying, correcting, or shielding their party, government, or policy.

Example (positive):

«Falso, no llegan ni al 1 %.» (rebutting opponents' fiscal claims in debate context)

— Carolina España Reina (PP). Unit spdb-v1-unassigned-c6349a3fb522.

Counterexample:

«*nos vemos obligados a abstenernos en esta votación.*»

— Íñigo Barandiaran Benito (EAJPNV). **Not defense** → position-taking / PF_ADVOCACY.

5.4 PF_PROPOSAL — Proposal / commitment

Definition: Commits to future action, concrete measure, or implementation pledge.

Decision rule: Explicit **forward-looking commitment** (legislative initiative, amendment pledge, implementation promise). General policy praise without commitment → PF_ADVOCACY.

Example (positive):

«*Desde ahora anunciamos que presentaremos una enmienda de eliminación [...] nos comprometemos a que en breve en esta Cámara se debata su toma en consideración.*»

— María Galovart Carrera (PSOE). Unit spdb-v1-unassigned-46bb18b3c74a.

Counterexample:

«*Comienza la votación.*» — Presidencia. **Not proposal** → PF_PROCEDURAL.

5.5 PF_APPEAL — Mobilization appeal

Definition: Seeks electoral or civic support via identity, values, fear, hope, or solidarity.

Decision rule: Dominant move **mobilises** audience (citizens, voters) through shared identity, hope, fear, or solidarity—not policy detail or opponent attack.

Example (positive):

«*A todos los españoles queremos transmitirles un mensaje de esperanza [...] juntos, con responsabilidad, pero también con determinación.*»

— María Montero Cuadrado (PSOE). Unit spdb-v1-unassigned-2063abcb1366.

Counterexample:

«*Creo que ha quedado muy claro quién quiere que este país pueda salir de la crisis [...] y quién prefiere que no.*»

— Same unit, different excerpt. **Not appeal** → implicit PF_ATTACK.

5.6 PF_INFO — Informational

Definition: Conveys factual or procedural information with minimal evaluative framing.

Decision rule: **Reports** facts, figures, bill contents, or technical information without dominant persuasion, attack, or mobilisation.

Example (positive):

«son tres principalmente las reformas que plantea esta proposición de ley [...] permitir la rectificación registral [...] suprimir la obligación de aportar documento médico [...]»

— Joseba Agirretxea Urresti (EAJPNV). Unit spdb-v1-unassigned-eb453642ca5f.

Counterexample:

Statistics deployed to condemn opponents' record → PF_ATTACK / PF_ADVOCACY, not neutral info.

5.7 PF_DEFLECT — Deflection / evasion

Definition: Avoids question or topic; pivots without substantive engagement.

Decision rule: Speaker **does not address** the pending question/bill/challenge and shifts topic. **Rare** in prepared plenary speech; expect low frequency and higher adjudication.

Example (positive):

Pivot from bill substance to criticising an opponent's newspaper terminology instead of engaging the law.

— Patricia Reyes Rivera (Cs). Unit spdb-v1-unassigned-e022d9750540.

Counterexample:

Direct rebuttal «No es así, señora Arrimadas» → PF_ATTACK / PF_DEFENSE, not deflect.

5.8 PF_PROCEDURAL — Ritual / procedural

Definition: Order of business, courtesy, formal parliamentary ritual with political context.

Decision rule: Presidencia (chair) managing agenda, speaking time, votes, rules; formulaic chamber management without substantive policy.

Example (positive):

«Comenzamos ahora, señorías, con el punto del orden del día [...] tiene la palabra el señor Rodríguez Rodríguez.»

— Presidencia. Unit spdb-v1-unassigned-88da342f1158.

Counterexample:

«Gracias, presidenta. [...] había 4,5 millones de españoles con graves problemas [...]»

— Substantive speech after courtesy → **not** procedural.

6. Master decision tree — fallacies

Fallacies are **multi-label** (max **3**). Label only moves **explicit in the span** (± 1 adjacent unit for context). Do not infer hidden intent.

```
START: Read unit (+ optional  $\pm 1$  context).

1. Is there NO reasoning move matching any FAL_* definition below?
  YES → FAL_NONE (fallacy_none_explicit=true; empty fallacy_labels)
  NO  → continue

2. For each suspected fallacy, verify definition in §7.
  - Ad hominem present? → FAL_ADHOM
  - Straw-man distortion present? → FAL_STRAW
  - False dilemma present? → FAL_DILEMMA
  - Slippery slope present? → FAL_SLOPE
  - Emotion/fear replaces evidence as primary warrant? → FAL_EMOTION
  - Hasty generalization present? → FAL_GENERAL
  - Whataboutism/tu quoque present? → FAL_WHATABOUT

3. If >3 fallacies suspected → keep top 3 by salience in this span.

4. Never combine FAL_NONE with any FAL_* label.

5. PF label is independent (code separately).
```

Evidence standard: A minimally competent reader of Spanish political discourse would agree the fallacy is present **in the span**.

Sarcasm/irony: Code the **literal rhetorical move**; flag `irony_possible=true` (analysis only, not a training label).

7. Political fallacy labels

Export: pipe-separated sorted IDs (e.g. FAL_ADHOM|FAL_WHATABOUT) or empty list + `fallacy_none_explicit=true`.

7.1 FAL_ADHOM — Ad hominem

Definition: Rejects or challenges a claim primarily via **personal attack** on the actor rather than the claim's merits.

Example (positive):

«Ustedes ni siquiera han estado sentados en la mesa donde se tomaban estas decisiones» — challenges Arrimadas' **standing**, not only the VAT policy merits.

Counterexample:

Evidence-based critique of a minister's **policy outcomes** with figures, without personal disqualification → no FAL_ADHOM (may still be PF_ATTACK).

Note: PF_ATTACK + FAL_ADHOM is common; PF_ATTACK without fallacy is valid when critique stays on policy/record with adequate evidential basis.

7.2 FAL_STRAW — Straw man / distortion

Definition: Misrepresents an opponent's position (stronger or weaker), then refutes the **distortion**.

Example (positive):

«Ustedes quieren eliminar todo el sector privado de la sanidad» when opponents proposed regulating one segment only — refuting an exaggerated caricature.

Counterexample:

Fair summary of opponent's published bill text followed by disagreement → not straw man.

7.3 FAL_DILEMMA — False dilemma

Definition: Presents two (or few) **exclusive** options when reasonable alternatives exist.

Example (positive):

«O están con la democracia española o están con el golpismo» — excludes intermediate positions or partial agreements.

Counterexample:

Binary vote on a **genuinely** two-option chamber division (sí/no to a single decree) described procedurally → not a false dilemma in argument.

7.4 FAL_SLOPE — Slippery slope

Definition: Claims an action **inevitably** leads to an extreme outcome without sufficient evidential steps.

Example (positive):

«Si permitimos esta enmienda, acabaremos disolviendo el Estado autonómico por completo» — no intermediate steps demonstrated.

Counterexample:

Cited chain of **documented** legislative precedents with explicit causal reasoning → not slippery slope (may be advocacy).

7.5 FAL_EMOTION — Appeal to emotion / fear

Definition: Replaces or evades evidentiary support with **fear, outrage, or pity** as the primary warrant.

Example (positive):

«Nuestros mayores morirán solos y abandonados» as the **main** reason to reject a bill, without policy engagement with the bill's measures.

Counterexample:

Citing **verified mortality statistics** from poverty-energy studies as evidence in policy advocacy → not emotion fallacy (may be PF_INFO / PF_ADVOCACY).

7.6 FAL_GENERAL — Hasty generalization

Definition: Generalizes from **unrepresentative or insufficient** evidence.

Example (positive):

«Un municipio gobernado por X colapsó; por tanto, X no puede gobernar España» — single case → national conclusion.

Counterexample:

Aggregate national statistics from official sources applied to a general claim → not hasty generalization.

7.7 FAL_WHATABOUT — Whataboutism / tu quoque

Definition: Deflects criticism by pointing to opponent's **unrelated or symmetric** behaviour without addressing the merit of the original charge.

Example (positive):

When asked about party financing transparency: «Y ustedes, ¿qué dicen del caso Gürtel?» — pivot without answering the question.

Counterexample:

Direct rebuttal with **on-topic** counter-evidence addressing the same policy domain → PF_DEFENSE, not whataboutism.

7.8 FAL_NONE — No fallacy

Definition: No fallacy from §7.1–7.7 is present in the span.

Export: fallacy_labels empty; fallacy_none_explicit=true. **Never** combine with any FAL_*.

8. Experimental labels (subset only)

Skip when experimental_subset=false.

ID	Name	Rule
SV_0	Semantic vacuity absent	Specifiable propositional political content

ID	Name	Rule
SV_1	Semantic vacuity present	Slogans, applause lines, content-free assent
SV_UNCLEAR	Unclear	< 3% of SV annotations
CA_0	Conceptual anachronism absent	Terms used in appropriate historical frame
CA_1	Conceptual anachronism present	Anachronistic projection onto past actors/events
CA_UNCLEAR	Unclear	< 3% of CA annotations

Experimental labels do **not** affect IberLEF leaderboard v1 ranking.

9. Edge cases compendium

#	Situation	PF guidance	Fallacy guidance
E1	Courtesy opener + long policy speech	Label substance	Code fallacies in full unit
E2	Presidencia with mild political remark	Still PF_PROCEDURAL if agenda management dominates	Usually FAL_NONE
E3	Quote of opponent then rebuttal	Label speaker's move , not quoted voice	Straw man if speaker distorts quote
E4	Rhetorical question attacking opponent	PF_ATTACK	FAL_EMOTION only if fear/outrage is primary warrant
E5	Manifesto programmatic list	Often PF_ADVOCACY or PF_PROPOSAL	Rare fallacies; avoid over-tagging
E6	Social-media post, sarcasm suspected	Code literal move; irony_possible=true	Do not guess hidden intent
E7	Policy attack with strong evidence	PF_ATTACK	No FAL_ADHOM if attack stays on merits/record
E8	«Todos los partidos menos nosotros»	Often PF_ATTACK or PF_APPEAL	Possible FAL_DILEMMA if exclusive framing
E9	Voting intention without new commitment	PF_ADVOCACY unless explicit pledge → PF_PROPOSAL	Usually none
E10	Multi-function long unit (segmentation error)	Pick dominant function; flag borderline	Top 3 fallacies by salience
E11	Speaker cites statistics from opponents	If correcting → PF_DEFENSE; if endorsing → PF_INFO/PF_ADVOCACY	Rare
E12	Empty or near-empty span	Should not appear in pool; escalate to PI	—

10. Adjudication rules

10.1 Triggers (mandatory queue)

- Any **pragmatic function** disagreement between annotators A and B.
- Any **fallacy** disagreement when PF already agrees (or after PF adjudicated).
- Any unit with `borderline=true` on PF.
- Gold-item failures below QC thresholds (§11).

10.2 Procedure

1. Read `adjudication_context` (prior labels) and ± 1 context units.
2. Re-apply decision trees (§4, §6) **without** defaulting to majority vote.
3. Set gold labels using the same controls as primary annotation.
4. Fill **Adjudication notes** with brief rationale, especially when overriding both annotators.
5. Record gold in export: `adjudicated=true`; log label delta in `adjudication_log.jsonl`.
6. Complete within **72 hours** of queue assignment.

10.3 Precedence

Conflict type	Rule
PF split between advocacy vs attack	Apply §4 tree; check primary target (policy vs actor)
PF split defense vs attack	Reactive → defense; offensive → attack
PF procedural vs info (chair)	Chair agenda → always procedural
Fallacy present vs none	Apply evidence standard ; when genuinely indeterminate after context, prefer none
>3 fallacies	Adjudicator selects top 3 by salience

10.4 Ontology changes

Adjudicators **must not** invent labels outside `labels/*.tsv`. Repeated confusion between the same pair (>10% of PF disagreements) triggers ontology/guideline revision (pilot go/no-go rule).

11. Quality control and reliability

11.1 Targets

Task	Metric	Codebook target	MVP release floor
Pragmatic function	Cohen's κ	> 0.80	≥ 0.67
Pragmatic function	Krippendorff's α	> 0.80	≥ 0.70
Fallacy (multi-label)	Macro-F1 (pairs)	≥ 0.60	≥ 0.48
Fallacy presence (binary)	Cohen's κ	≥ 0.70	≥ 0.52

11.2 Training protocol (to reach $\kappa > 0.80$)

1. Read this codebook and annotation/labelstudio/instructions.md.
2. Complete **5 practice units** (excluded from κ) with group review.
3. Annotate pilot batch; review disagreements with lead annotator.
4. Do **not** begin production until pilot PF $\kappa \geq 0.67$; recalibrate if below.
5. Monthly refresher on top confusion pairs from disagreement reports.

11.3 Hidden gold items

Maintain $\geq 85\%$ agreement on PF and $\geq 75\%$ on fallacies on 5% hidden gold subset during production.

11.4 Borderline budget

borderline=true on PF expected $\leq 5\%$ of submissions; higher rates trigger guideline clarification.

12. Quick reference — label IDs

Pragmatic function

ID	Name
PF_ADVOCACY	Policy advocacy
PF_ATTACK	Position attack
PF_DEFENSE	Defense / rebuttal
PF_PROPOSAL	Proposal / commitment
PF_APPEAL	Mobilization appeal
PF_INFO	Informational
PF_DEFLECT	Deflection / evasion
PF_PROCEDURAL	Ritual / procedural

Fallacies

ID	Name
FAL_ADHOM	Ad hominem
FAL_STRAW	Straw man / distortion
FAL_DILEMMA	False dilemma
FAL_SLOPE	Slippery slope
FAL_EMOTION	Appeal to emotion / fear
FAL_GENERAL	Hasty generalization
FAL_WHATABOUT	Whataboutism / tu quoque
FAL_NONE	No fallacy (explicit)

13. Related files

Path	Content
labels/pragmatic_functions.tsv	PF ontology (machine-readable)
labels/fallacies.tsv	Fallacy ontology
annotation/guidelines/pragmatic_function_examples.md	Extended ParlaMint worked examples
annotation/labelstudio/instructions.md	Label Studio UI workflow
annotation/pilot_001/pilot_protocol.md	Pilot workflow
scripts/analysis/compute_cohen_kappa.py	Agreement analysis toolkit

Revision history

Version	Date	Changes
1.0.0	2026-06-18	Initial complete codebook: PF + fallacies, decision trees, adjudication, IA target $\kappa > 0.80$